

Avinash Agarwal

Mathematics | Engineering | Artificial Intelligence | Distributed Systems

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The United States of America

SUMMARY

Curiosity-driven engineering veteran with 8 years of industry-leading experience at Meta and Microsoft; specializing in full-stack development, distributed cloud infrastructure, and high-throughput data-pipelines. Proven track record of designing and managing high-volume distributed systems processing billions of daily notifications. Passionate about leveraging Artificial Intelligence and Distributed Systems to solve complex planet-scale engineering challenges.

EXPERIENCE

Meta

Software Engineer

August 2025 - Present

Menlo Park, California, USA

- **Architecting and scaling Meta's global Credentials Infrastructure for Authentication Methods**, enhancing the security, reliability, and performance of identity systems processing **billions of authentication requests** across the entire Meta ecosystem.
- **Driving end-to-end product testing within Meta Superintelligence Labs**, ensuring stability, scalability, and peak performance for the Meta AI app.
- **Secured runners-up position in an internal Hackathon**, demonstrating high engineering velocity by rapidly diagnosing and resolving a high volume of bugs and edge cases across the codebase.
- **Improved on-call efficiency by integrating an automated on-call agent**, streamlining incident response and reducing manual triage for the engineering team.

Azure Core, Microsoft

Software Engineer

Feb 2022 - July 2025

Redmond, Washington, USA

Core Engineering | [Azure Resource Graph](#)

- Significantly reduced partition skewness in data-ingestion pipelines, achieving **over 30%** improvement in compute, memory and network efficiency.
- Advocated for **increasing hash cardinality** across the storage stack, significantly improving distribution granularity and partition skewness.
- **Engineered data ingestion components** hosted on the Azure Synapse platform to support dynamic time-window loading for security datasets.
- Optimized complex SQL queries executed on Azure Synapse to efficiently load and merge multiple continuous data streams.
- Led migration of a streaming data pipeline (1B+ daily notifications) to its dedicated scale unit — Involved sophisticated design, careful cross-team planning and execution.
- Profiled and optimized high-contention services eliminating bottlenecks and achieving **nearly 10%** improvement in compute, memory and network efficiency.
- Improved on-call efficiency with multiple improvements to internal monitors, documentations, etc.

Engineering Lead | [Azure Resource Change Analysis](#)

- Delivered General Availability for the Change Analysis back-end by successfully deploying the service to US and China Government Sovereign Clouds, ahead of an important Gartner cloud review.
- Led the architectural evolution, including metadata enhancements and optimizations to the Change Analysis payload with extensive collaboration across teams and disciplines.
- Delivered General Availability for the [Change Actor](#) functionality, enabling customers to audit **who** initiated a change and **which client** (Portal, CLI, SDK) was used to make these changes.
- Delivered General Availability for the Change Analysis front-end (live on the Azure portal) by improving performance Lighthouse scores, deployment and test automation, accessibility fixes etc.

Engineering Lead | Scaling for GRAB (Strategic Partnership)

- Collaborated with a specialist engineering partner to perform intensive load testing and performance profiling, ensuring platform stability for massive-scale deployment across Southeast Asia.
- Optimized core services to achieve a **20x throughput improvement** by studying and refining SQL query execution plans, eliminating redundant network calls, and implementing strategic caching layers.
- Architected APIs to execute the **migration of 160M+ customer records from AWS to Azure**, designing robust APIs to ensure zero-downtime and data integrity during the transition.
- Spearheaded technical design reviews and PM alignment, advocating for extensible solutions to avoid technical debt from short-term fixes.

Engineering Lead | UNICEF Learning Passport (powered by Microsoft Community Training)

- **Offline Innovation (Hackathon Lead):** Spearheaded a hackathon project to host the entire cloud service locally on Windows machines. The platform was recognized as one of **TIME's Best Inventions of 2021** for providing continuous education to children in conflict zones and refugee settings.
- **Global Societal Impact:** This "offline-first" prototype was the key technical catalyst that prompted **UNICEF** to launch the initiative using Microsoft Community Training for no-connectivity regions, contributing to a high-scale initiative that reached **7.4 million learners across 43 countries** by 2024;
- **Strategic Architectural Leadership:** Successfully advocated for, and worked on containerization and migration to **cross-platform .NET Core**; this move was critical for the platform's ability to run on diverse hardware in emerging markets like Zimbabwe, Lebanon, and Honduras.
- **Operational Support & Edge Strategy:** Facilitated the integration of **Azure IoT Hub** to support remote management and observability for offline learning hubs; assisted in testing data-sync on diverse Linux-based hardware to ensure reliable curriculum delivery in remote field operations.

Engineering Lead | Swachh Bharat Mission (powered by Project Sangam)

- * Directed an engineering team through the end-to-end implementation of key mobile features, culminating in the successful launch of the official **Swachh Bharat Mission eLearning mobile app**.
- * Spearheaded the rapid triage of launch-critical issues in close collaboration with Product Management, ensuring a smooth migration of the training platform.
- * Architected and implemented a high-impact search-enabled dropdown to resolve a critical UI bug; this allowed users to efficiently navigate and select from **the hundreds of cities where the platform was deployed**.
- * **Contributed to a high-scale social impact project** that successfully trained and empowered over **110,000+ municipal functionaries** across **4,000+ cities** in India.

Engineering Lead | Platform Localization

- * Spearheaded global accessibility by **engineering an internal localization framework** and integrating with manual translation pipelines.
- * Initially developed comprehensive support for **right-to-left (RTL) formats** before assuming full platform localization ownership.
- * Conducted a **comprehensive investigation on ligature support** to ensure accurate rendering of complex scripts across the ecosystem.

Engineering Lead | Notifications Infrastructure

- Initially onboarded via Xamarin consumption APIs before assuming full ownership of the platform's notification subsystem, overseeing both backend delivery and frontend integration.
- **Team Leadership & Mentorship:** Mentored interns, full-time colleagues, and onboarding buddies; conducted technical design reviews and proactively collaborated with partner teams to align cross-functional engineering goals.
- **Designed a robust global load-balancing solution and BCDR solution** using Azure Front Door, significantly improving page load performance and security.
- **High-Throughput Bulk Ingestion:** Architected and built an end-to-end bulk upload system enabling parallel ingestion of multi-format media; significantly reduced administrative onboarding time and **super-charged the manual testing experience** for everyone.
- **Developed a scalable monitoring infrastructure** using Event Hubs and Azure Data Explorer to centralize telemetry and enable diagnostic and analytic dashboards.
- **Automated end-to-end deployments and CI/CD pipelines**, enabling the Public Preview release and publishing of the final offering on the Azure Marketplace.

- **Identity & Authentication:** Streamlined the SMS-based login flow by implementing custom Identity Server solutions over Azure Cosmos DB and closely collaborated with Telesign to significantly reduce SMS code-sending costs across many countries.
- **Search Infrastructure & Optimization:** Designed and implemented a custom search index featuring advanced schema optimizations and Lucene-based retrieval.
 - * Integrated with custom skills to extract metadata from PDFs, videos, and documents into indexed columns.
 - * Enhanced discovery by implementing **fuzzy matching, synonym mapping, and phonetic analyzers** using Azure Cognitive Search to improve query relevance.
- **Media Security & DRM:** Authored a technical proposal to modernize content protection for temporal media using industry-standard **DRM (Digital Rights Management)** including **Widevine, PlayReady, and FairPlay** over existing/legacy AES-128 encryption.
- **Advanced Threat Modeling:** Conducted deep-dive threat modeling and attack surface analysis using Microsoft internal security frameworks; ensuring the integrity of user data and platform content.
- **Privacy & Compliance:** Enabled automated compliance tooling to automate the identification of secure, licensed dependencies; ensuring rigorous adherence to global data protection and privacy standards.
- **State Persistence & User Analytics:** Developed features for real-time tracking of user progress, including "most recently viewed lesson" and "last watched timestamp" for temporal media content ensuring a seamless cross-device learning experience.
- **Delivered end-to-end features and bug fixes** spanning data layers, backend services, and frontend components.

Microsoft Foundry

Software Engineering Internship

May 2016 - July 2016
Hyderabad, Telangana, India

- Engineered and deployed Azure-hosted chat-bots using the **Microsoft Bot Framework**, specifically architecting custom conversational flows for automated form-filling. Helped with OpenCV usage for improved OCR performance and test Microsoft's LUIS for a more natural language experience.

Xerox Research Centre, India

Machine Learning Internship

Dec 2015 - Jan 2016
Bengaluru, Karnataka, India

- **Xerox Research Innovation Challenge:** Engineered predictive neural network models using vitals and lab data to forecast patient mortality and health complications among ICU patients.
- Secured **3rd place** (online) and **7th place** (onsite) in the challenge alongside a 3-person team, successfully competing against advanced Ph.D. research teams.
- Completed an intensive Winter School on Machine Learning under the mentorship of [Prof. Vaibhav Rajan](#).

PROJECTS

- **AIMA-CSharp Open Source Contribution:** Contributed to the [AIMA-CSharp repository](#) by implementing pseudo-code in C# from Peter Norvig's *Artificial Intelligence: A Modern Approach*.
- **Image Steganography:** Implemented a system to encrypt and embed hidden messages within images.
- **IoT Home Automation::** Retrofitting legacy electric switches with motorized 3D-printed actuators and control software.
- **Kool AI(d) for Gamers:** Extracted live game metrics and game states from DotA-2 streams for real-time analytics.
- **The Chess Game:** A chess game with AI using Mini-Max and Alpha-Beta pruning, with multiplayer support.
- **Multi-Agent Environment Simulation:** Built a 2D grid simulation of agents coordinating with one another.
- **2D Physics Game Engine:** Developed a custom rigid-body and gravitational physics engine in Java focusing on real-time kinematic interactions.
 - Implemented efficient **collision detection and resolution** for multiple dynamic objects.
 - Engineered an **environmental boundary system** to manage object interactions with surrounding walls.
 - Implemented a **Near-Earth constant gravity model** to [simulate realistic downward acceleration](#).
 - Implemented a **Newtonian $1/r^2$ gravity model** to simulate object interaction in space.
- **Intel E5200 CPU Overclocking:** Successfully overclocked an Intel Pentium E5200 processor from a base clock of **2.5GHz to 2.8GHz** to improve gaming performance on budget hardware.
 - Optimized system performance by manually adjusting **FSB frequencies, CPU multipliers, and core voltage settings** within the BIOS to achieve a stable 12% frequency increase.
 - Conducted extensive stress testing to monitor thermal output and system stability under peak loads, ensuring long-term hardware reliability and optimal heat dissipation.

- Benchmarked and Documented performance gains on hardware-intensive titles such as Grand Theft Auto IV.
- **Top-Down Space Shooter (Unity):** Developed a 2D top-down space shooter game using the Unity game engine.
- **Predicting Tourism Trends:** Worked on building statistical and machine learning models to forecast tourism trends.
- **Robo-Soccer:** Placed runner-up in a team of 5 at a Robo-Soccer event organized by Technex, IIT Varanasi.
- **Tic-Tac-Toe AI:** Implemented a decision-tree based AI and multi-player for Tic-Tac-Toe.

EDUCATION

Indian Institute of Technology (BHU) - Varanasi

Integrated Master's degree (5 years): Mathematics & Computing

*July 2013 - May 2018
Varanasi, India*

- **Problem Setter & Moderator – Hackerrank (Technex'16):**
 - * **Mathletics:** www.hackerrank.com/mathletics-technex16
 - * **Prayaas:** www.hackerrank.com/prayaas-technex16
- **Teaching Assistant** for the freshman course on **Mathematical Methods**.
- Thesis: Deep Learning Based Classification of Handwritten Mathematical Symbols (Supervised by [Prof. T. Som](#))
- Skills/Technologies used: Pandas, NumPy, TensorFlow, Keras, CNNs, Scikit-learn, AWS etc.
- Trained transfer learning models achieving state-of-the-art accuracy on the HasyV2 dataset.
- **DeepLearning.AI:** [Deep Learning Specialization](#) *August 2017*
- **University of Alberta & Amii:** [Reinforcement Learning Specialization](#) *July 2020*
- **The State University of New York:** [Blockchain Basics](#) *June 2021*
- **DeepLearning.AI:** [Generative AI For Software Development](#) *February 2025*

ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- **Competitive Programming, Machine Learning and Quant**
 - Qualified for and represented IIT Varanasi at **ACM-ICPC 2016 Regionals**
 - Qualified for and represented IIT Varanasi at **ACM-ICPC 2015 Regionals**
 - Ranked 15th worldwide (2nd in India) in **Codeforces Round 410**
 - Finalist of GS Quantify 2016 (2nd in India), a flagship event, organized by **Goldman Sachs**
 - Ranked 1st in COPS-OPC-2015, a programming contest organized by the club of programmers at IIT Varanasi
 - Ranked 1st in CodeDef 2016, a coding contest organized in Udyam, a college festival of IIT Varanasi
 - Ranked 14th out of 3,000+ participants in the IndiaHacks Machine Learning track
 - Ranked 2nd in Analiticity, a campus-wide Data Science competition at Technex '16
 - Ranked 83rd worldwide in **Google Kickstart** Round D 2017
- **Academic**
 - All India Rank 1672 in IIT-JEE (ADVANCED) - 2013, among 150k candidates
 - All India Rank 494 in Joint Entrance Examination - JEE (MAINS) - 2013, among 1.3 million candidates
 - All India Rank 6355 in National Eligibility cum Entrance Tests (NEET) - 2013, among 650k candidates
 - Achieved Rank 1 in Medical stream of Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination - 2013
 - Achieved Rank 2 in Engineering stream of Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination - 2013
 - Awarded DST INSPIRE Science Scholarship for ranking in the top 1% of AISSCE 2013
 - Scored 96.8% in the All India Senior School Certificate Examination
 - Recognized in the top 0.1% of AISSCE 2013 for excellence in Physical Education

SKILLS

- **Engineering Leadership:** Technical Design Reviews, Mentorship & Team Leading, On-call Engineering & Incident Response, Security & Privacy Reviews, Threat Modeling, Cross-functional Collaboration.
- **AI / Machine Learning:** LLM Applications & Agentic Workflows, Reinforcement Learning, Deep Learning (CNNs), Transfer Learning, Neural Networks, Computer Vision.
- **Backend & Distributed Systems:** High-Scale Services (Billions of daily requests), Distributed Systems Architecture, API Design, Data Pipelines, Authentication & Identity Systems, Blockchain, BCDR (Business Continuity & Disaster Recovery).
- **Data & Storage:** Blockchain, NoSQL/SQL, Redis, Search Infrastructure (Lucene/Elasticsearch).
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** Microsoft Azure (Expert), AWS, Kubernetes, CDN, CI/CD & Infrastructure Automation.
- **Frameworks & Libraries:** .NET / ASP.NET Core, React, TensorFlow, Keras, Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, XGBoost, OpenCV, Unity, IronPDF.
- **Programming Languages:** C, C++, C#, Java, Python, TypeScript, Scala, Hack/PHP, SQL, PowerShell, Octave
- **Natural Languages:** English and Hindi.